

Misinformation related to menstruation and menopause often includes incorrect statements and misleading information pertaining to menstruation, the menstrual cycle, and menopause that can contribute to societal, religious, healthcare, financial inequity for people who menstruate.

Etiology

About 26% of the female population is of reproductive age and a majority of those have menstrual cycles. As menstruating people are present in all societies, taboos regarding menstruation are also prevalent in many societies around the world. Misinformation regarding menstruation primarily arise from these taboos, often associating menstrual blood with uncleanness or placing some spiritual significance on the menstrual cycle itself.

Misinformation around menopause, on the other hand, tends to focus around misconceptions regarding aging, sexual function, and hormone replacement.

Common misinformation regarding menstruation

Common misinformation regarding menopause

Menopause is defined as 12 consecutive months without a period (in the absence of other potential causes of amenorrhea). This is a natural event that marks the permanent end of menstruation and fertility.

References

External links

The North Carolina Menopause Society: MenoNotes

ACOG FAQ: The Menopause Years